

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 913

By Littleton

A RESOLUTION to recognize and commend the outstanding work of Jobs for America's Graduates in Tennessee and to highlight the exceptional return on the State's investment in this vital program.

WHEREAS, Jobs for America's Graduates Tennessee (JAGTN), an affiliate of the national Jobs for America's Graduates organization, is a nonprofit dedicated to guiding high school students toward graduation while equipping them with essential skills for employability, postsecondary education, and lifelong success; and

WHEREAS, founded in 1981 under Governor Lamar Alexander and initially exclusively state-funded, JAGTN is now one of the longest-serving affiliates of Jobs for America's Graduates; since 2013, it has expanded through diverse partnerships with school districts, private businesses, and regional nonprofits to serve forty-two schools across thirty counties; and

WHEREAS, in order to fulfill its mission, JAGTN empowers students with the tools to excel in the workforce, education, and life and tracks graduates for one full year after high school to ensure they remain on a path toward career or college; and

WHEREAS, the program has demonstrated remarkable outcomes, including a 99.8 percent graduation rate for its students in 2025, far surpassing the statewide average of 90 percent, and securing \$59.6 million in postsecondary scholarships for the Class of 2025; and

WHEREAS, JAGTN participants achieve 80 percent positive outcomes, such as employment, postsecondary enrollment, or military service, with 60 percent entering the workforce—60 percent of whom secure full-time positions—and show significant improvements in GPA, attendance, self-esteem, and reductions in barriers and discipline referrals; and

WHEREAS, the program's impact extends to broader societal benefits, fostering confident graduates who become productive citizens and leaders in Tennessee's communities and economy; and

WHEREAS, JAGTN delivers an extraordinary return on investment for the State of Tennessee, yielding \$25.50 in economic benefits for every \$1.00 invested through enhanced productivity, reduced social costs, and increased workforce readiness; and

WHEREAS, this impressive return on investment underscores the program's efficiency and value, making it a model public-private partnership that amplifies State resources while addressing critical needs in education and workforce development; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we hereby recognize and commend Jobs for America's Graduates Tennessee for its exemplary work in transforming the lives of Tennessee's high school students and delivering substantial returns on the State's investment.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.